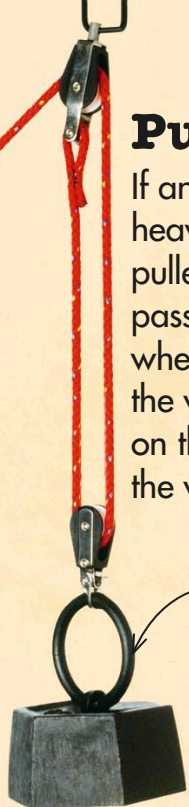


Pulley

If an object is very heavy, you can use a pulley to lift it. A rope is passed over the top of a wheel and attached to the weight. You pull on the rope to lift the weight.

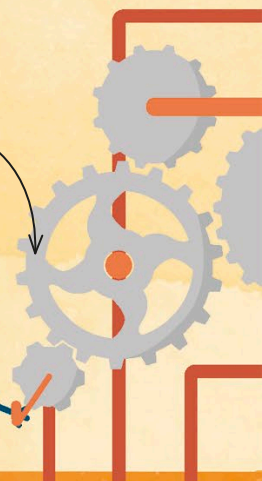
The weight is hooked onto the pulley.



Gears

Gears are connected wheels with sticky-out bits called spokes. A smaller, lighter wheel is turned by hand. The spokes catch the heavier wheel to push it round.

This wheel is too heavy to move by hand.



Lever

You use a lever to lift things. An example of a lever is a plank balanced on a single point called a fulcrum.

If I push down here, the weights lift up!

The fulcrum is near the middle.

You wouldn't be able to lift these weights by hand.



Wedge

A triangular wedge is used to split things in two. The wedge is swung downwards into the object.

An axe is a type of wedge.



Ramp

To raise or lower an object that is too heavy to lift, we can push it along smooth ramps that slope upwards or downwards.

A wheeled cart carries the object.

